

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

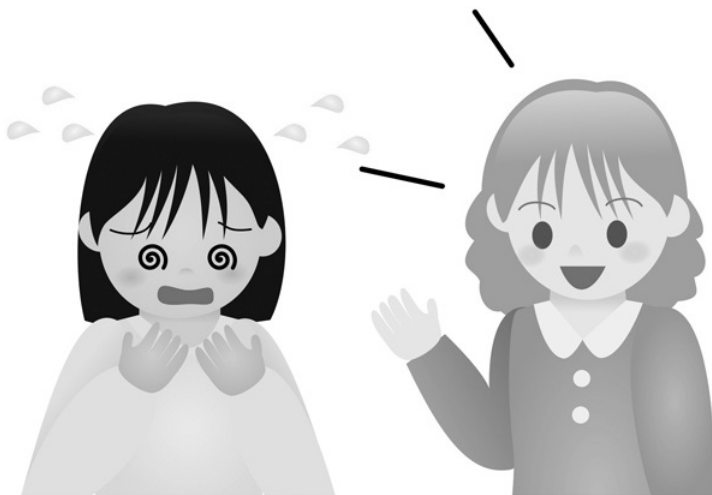
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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: May I speak to you in your office?



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Describe a time when you faced a stressful situation at work or school. How did you handle it?
- Have you met with someone to talk about your position? What happened? Was it stressful?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about emotions, opinions and behavior in a work situation.
- I can write about what I will be doing or what I will have done.
- I can ask for clarification and ask for someone's opinion.

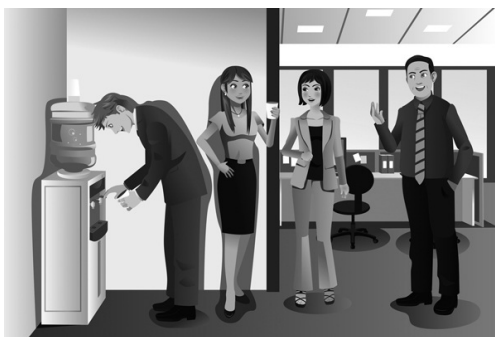




Let's Explore!

Allen and Joseph chat in the lunchroom about **workplace tension***.

* "Workplace tension" is when you are working in a stressful environment.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Allen:** Hi Joseph. Your lunch looks delicious. Leftovers?
- Joseph:** My wife outdid herself. Last night's seafood lasagna was spectacular.
- Allen:** Did you hear about the latest deadline? I'm really concerned that we'll not be able to finish the project in time.
- Joseph:** Yes, I was in this morning's boardroom meeting. It sounds like the accounting department is concerned about excessive spending, doesn't it? They seemed pretty agitated when we were discussing the need for new equipment.
- Allen:** Absolutely! They always have their eye on the bottom line. The CFO also mentioned that we will need to make some changes within the company. Some people in engineering will be moved to construction and they will be considering redundancies too. I think the company is struggling financially.
- Joseph:** Finding a permanent, stable job in this industry is a challenge, isn't it? The housing market is so unstable.
- Allen:** I agree. I'm on a one-year contract. Maybe I should start looking for other employment.
- Joseph:** It might not be a bad idea. If you like, I'll forward you an e-mail I received from a colleague who works for *Constructionzone* when I finish lunch. They are looking for someone.
- Allen:** Another contract? I'd be hesitant to simply change for change's sake.
- Joseph:** I believe that it is a permanent job. They are desperate to fill the position.
- Allen:** Sounds interesting. I'll be sitting in on meetings all afternoon. You will have left the office by the time it finishes, but I'll have a look tonight. You have my new e-mail address, don't you?
- Joseph:** AllenShaw@Webuild.net, right?
- Allen:** Correct. I'll be looking forward to reading the position description. It sounds like a great opportunity. Thanks!





Let's Practice!

Allen and Joesph continue to talk about the office.

Instructions: Circle the incorrect words in the sentence. Write the correction in the blank spaces.

1. Some people in engineering will be move to construction and they will be considering redundancies too.

2. I'll been sitting in meetings all afternoon. I'll have a look tonight.

3. You will had left the office by the time it finishes but I'll have a look tonight.

4. The team will have been worked on the project for over six months by the time it is finished.

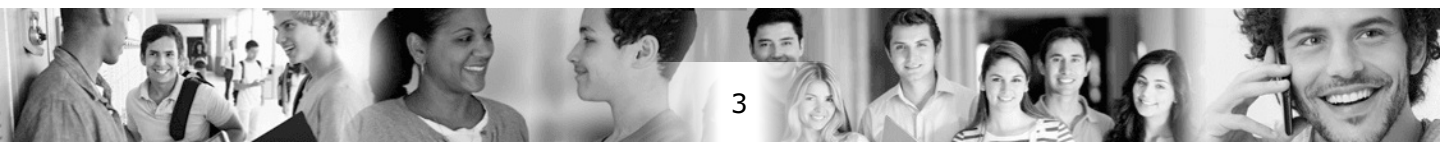


Let's Practice!

Imagine that there are some major changes happening at work.

Instructions: Write a 120-150 word diary entry about changes at work.

1. Include a date and greeting.
2. Describe the issues at work.
3. Explain how you feel about the situation.
4. Express your opinion.
5. Include the Future Continuous tense and the Future Perfect tense in your entry.





Extension Activity

How do you cope with stress?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- In groups of three, create a poster detailing all of the stresses in one week of your life.
- Then brainstorm with your group about all the ways we can cope with that stress.
- Make a short group presentation of 3 to 5 minutes to the class explaining your poster and the methods of coping with stress.
- Write a paragraph about your biggest cause of stress and how you handle it.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I brainstorm about causes of stress.

☐ ☐

I make a short group presentation explaining the types of stress and how to cope with stress.

☐ ☐

I write about my biggest personal cause of stress and how I handle it.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to outdo** (verb): to perform better
e.g. My wife outdid herself.
- **excessive** (adjective): to go beyond the necessary or usual
e.g. It sounds like the accounting department is concerned about excessive spending, doesn't it?
- **agitated** (adjective): excite or emotionally
e.g. They seemed pretty agitated when were were discussing the need for new equipment.
- **the bottom line** (expression): to the last line of a financial statement
e.g. They always have their eye on the bottom line.
- **redundancy** (noun): the use of additional or extra systems
e.g. They will be considering redundancies too.
- **change for change's sake** (expression): to change to obtain a benefit
e.g. I'd be hesitant to simply change for change's sake.



Learning Points

Future Continuous Tense and Future Perfect Tense

You use the Future Continuous tense to talk about an unfinished action or event that will be in progress at a time later than now.

You use the Future Perfect tense to refer to a completed action in the future.

The Future Continuous tense is made up of two parts:

the simple future of the verb "to be" + the present participle (base + *ing*)

The Future Continuous tense can also be used to project ourselves into the future.

The Future Perfect tense is also made up of two parts:

the simple future of the verb "to have" (*will have*) + the past participle of the main verb

When you use this tense you are projecting yourself forward into the future and looking back at an action that will be completed some time later than now.

You often use the Future Perfect tense with a time expression.

Examples:

- *Some people in engineering will be moved to construction and they will be considering redundancies too.*
- *I'll be sitting in meetings all afternoon. I'll have a look tonight.*
- *You will have left the office by the time it finishes but I'll have a look tonight.*





Learning Points

Tag Questions

A tag question is a statement that is followed by a mini-question. You use a tag question to ask for confirmation.

Tag questions are used to mean "Do you agree?" or "Is that right?"

The basic structure is:

positive statement	negative tag
<i>Your project is due tomorrow,</i>	<i>isn't it?</i>
negative statement	positive tag
<i>You're not interested in leaving,</i>	<i>are you?</i>

The tag repeats the auxiliary verb (or main verb when *be*) from the statement and changes it to negative or positive.

Examples:

- *You have my new e-mail address, don't you?*
- *Finding a permanent, stable job in this industry is a challenge, isn't it?*

